THE PRIME MINISTER'S OFFICE
REGIONAL ADMINISTRATION AND LOCAL GOVERNMENT
LONGIDO DISTRICT MID TERM JOINT EXAMINATION

FORM ONE
036 COMPUTER SCIENCE
MARKING SCHEME SEPTEMBER 2026

SECTION A (15 MARKS)

1. **Multiple Choice Questions — 10 Marks**

(i)	(ii)	(iii)	(iv)	(v)	(vi)	(vii)	(viii)	(ix)	(x)
B	C	B	A	C	B	A	A	B	B

2. **Matching Items — 5 Marks**

(i)	(ii)	(iii)	(iv)	(v)
B	C	D	A	E

SECTION B (70 MARKS)

3.

(a) Define Computer Science. **(3 marks)**

Computer Science is the study of **computers, information, computation and computational processes**, including how computer systems are designed and used to solve problems.

(b) Any three:

(i) Education
(ii) Banking and financial services
(iii) Communication
(iv) Health/medicine
(v) Transport
(vi) Business
(vii) Entertainment
(viii) Agriculture
(ix) Government services

(c) Any two well-explained points:

(i) Improves problem-solving and logical-thinking skills.
(ii) Helps students use computers and digital technologies effectively.
(iii) Supports research, learning and access to educational resources.
(iv) Provides useful skills for future employment and careers.
(v) Helps students understand programming and technology.

4.

(a) A computer system is a combination of hardware, software, data and/or users/procedures working together to input, process, store and produce information.**(3 marks)**

(b) Name three major components of a computer system. (3 marks)

(i) Hardware
(ii) Software
(iii) Data
(iv) People/users
(v) Procedures

(c) **(4 marks)**

- Hardware consists of the physical parts of the computer.
- Software provides instructions for the hardware.
- The software sends instructions to hardware such as the CPU.
- The hardware carries out the instructions to perform the required task.

5.

(a) Computer hardware refers to the physical parts/components of a computer system that can be seen and touched.

(b) Functions of three hardware devices. **(3 marks)**

Any three:

Keyboard — used to enter text, numbers and commands.
Mouse — used to point, select and control items on the screen.
Monitor — displays information and results.
Printer — produces hard copies of information.
CPU — processes instructions and controls computer operations.

(c) **Distinguish input and output devices.**

- **Input devices** are devices used to enter data or instructions into a computer.
  - Example: **Keyboard** or **mouse**.
- **Output devices** are devices used to present processed information from a computer to the user.
  - Example: **Monitor** or **printer** may be accepted as the example where appropriately stated.

6.

(a) Computer software is a set of programs/instructions that tells a computer what to do or how to perform particular tasks.**(3 marks)**

(b) Three examples of computer software. **(3 marks)**

Any three:
(i) Microsoft Word
(ii) Windows
(iii) Microsoft Excel
(iv) Google Chrome
(v) PowerPoint
(vi) Paint
(vii) Antivirus software
(viii) VLC Media Player

(c) **(4 marks)**

System software:

- Manages and controls computer hardware and provides a platform for other software.
- Example: Windows operating system.

Application software:

- Designed to help users perform specific tasks.
- Example: Microsoft Word.

7.

(a) Three rules for proper handling and care. **(3 marks)**

Any three:

(i) Keep food and drinks away from computers.

(ii) Handle keyboards, mice and other equipment gently.

(iii) Do not pull cables forcefully.

(iv) Keep computers clean and free from dust.

(v) Cover computers when they are not in use.

(vi) Keep computers in a well-ventilated place.

(vii) Switch computers off properly after use.

(b) Three unsafe practices in the scenario. **(3 marks)**

The unsafe practices include:

(i) Eating food near the computer.

(ii) Pulling cables forcefully.

(iii) Any implication of careless handling; however, covering the computer after use is a safe practice and should not be penalised.

(iv) Since the scenario explicitly gives only two unsafe practices, award:

(v) Third mark for identifying another relevant unsafe practice from the student's explanation, such as careless handling or failure to keep equipment clean, if appropriately justified.

(c) Two effects of poor handling and care. **(4 marks)**

Any two:

(i) Computer components may become damaged.

(ii) Electrical faults or short circuits may occur if liquids are spilled.

(iii) Dust may cause overheating and reduce performance.

(iv) Cables may become damaged, causing loss of power or connectivity.

(v) Repairs and replacement costs may increase.

(vi) The useful life of the computer may be reduced.

8.

(a) Computer system maintenance is the regular care, cleaning, checking, updating and repair of computer systems to keep them working properly and efficiently. **(3 marks)**

(b) Three maintenance activities. **(3 marks)**

Any three:

(i) Cleaning dust from the computer and keyboard.

(ii) Updating the operating system and software.

(iii) Running antivirus scans.

(iv) Removing unnecessary files.

(v) Checking and arranging cables.

(vi) Checking hardware for faults.

(vii) Backing up important data.

(viii) Ensuring proper ventilation.

(c) Two benefits of regular maintenance. **(4 marks)**

Any two:

(i) Improves computer performance and speed.

(ii) Prevents or reduces hardware/software problems.

(iii) Extends the useful life of computer equipment.

(iv) Protects data from some forms of malware or data loss.

(v) Reduces repair and replacement costs.

(vi) Improves reliability.

9.

(a) Troubleshooting is the systematic process of identifying, diagnosing and correcting problems or faults in a computer system.**(3 marks)**

(b) Three things to check before concluding the computer is damaged. **(3 marks)**

Any three:

(i) Check whether the power cable is properly connected.
(ii) Check whether the power socket/switch is working.
(iii) Check whether the computer's power button has been pressed correctly.
(iv) Check whether the monitor is switched on.
(v) Check the monitor's power and display cables.
(vi) Check whether other connected devices/cables are properly connected.

(c) Two general steps for solving a computer problem. **(4 marks)**

Any two well-described steps:

(i) Identify and understand the problem — observe the symptoms and determine what is not working correctly.
(ii) Check possible causes and test solutions — inspect connections, settings or components and apply an appropriate solution.

SECTION C (15 MARKS)

10. The essay should address all four areas:

A. Proper handling and care — 4 marks

(i) Keep food and drinks away from computers.
(ii) Handle equipment gently.
(iii) Do not pull or bend cables forcefully.
(iv) Keep computers covered when not in use.
(v) Keep the laboratory clean and dust-free.
(vi) Ensure proper ventilation.
(vii) Switch computers off correctly.

Maximum: 4 marks

B. Simple computer maintenance — 3 marks

Relevant points include:

(i) Clean keyboards, monitors and other equipment.
(ii) Remove dust regularly.
(iii) Keep cables properly arranged.
(iv) Update software and operating systems.
(v) Run antivirus checks.
(vi) Delete unnecessary files.
(vii) Back up important data.

Maximum: 3 marks

C. Preventing common computer problems — 3 marks

Relevant points include:

(i) Avoid spilling liquids on computers.
(ii) Protect computers from dust and overheating.
(iii) Use antivirus software and keep it updated.
(iv) Avoid installing unknown or unnecessary software.
(v) Shut down computers properly.
(vi) Use suitable electrical power protection where available.
(vii) Handle equipment carefully.

D. Troubleshooting simple problems — 3 marks
Relevant points include:

(i) Identify and understand the problem.
(ii) Check power connections and switches.
(iii) Check cables and peripheral devices.
(iv) Restart the computer when appropriate.
(v) Check simple software/settings problems.
(vi) Test whether the solution has worked.
(vii) Report serious faults to the teacher or technician rather than attempting unsafe repairs.

Total: 15 marks